Expense and Reimbursement Policy

Document ID: NL-FIN-001 | Version: 3.1 | Effective: 1 April 2026 | Owner: Finance

1. Principles

Employees are reimbursed for reasonable, pre-approved business expenses. Expenses must be submitted on the ExpenseFlow portal within 30 calendar days of the expense date. Claims submitted after 30 days are rejected unless the Finance Controller approves an exception in writing.

2. Approval Limits

Claim amount (per claim)	Approver
Up to INR 5,000	Reporting manager
INR 5,001 to INR 25,000	Department head
Above INR 25,000	Finance Controller and the department VP

Receipts or invoices are required for every expense above INR 500. Expenses of INR 500 or less can be claimed with a short description. Splitting one expense into several claims to avoid an approval limit is a policy violation.

3. Travel

- Flights: economy class for flights under 6 hours, premium economy for flights of 6 hours or more. Business class is not reimbursable unless the CEO approves it.
- Book travel at least 7 days in advance through the company travel desk (travel@nimbuslabs.example) to get corporate fares.
- Trains: AC 2-tier or equivalent. Local cabs are reimbursable when public transport is unavailable or the trip is after 9:00 PM.
- Personal vehicle use for business travel: INR 12 per km for a car and INR 5 per km for a two-wheeler, with a trip log.

Hotel city category	Maximum per night
Tier 1 (Mumbai, Delhi NCR, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Chennai)	INR 7,000
Tier 2 (all other Indian cities, including Jaipur)	INR 4,500
International	USD 180

4. Meals and Client Entertainment

- Meal per diem while travelling: INR 1,200 per day in India and USD 60 per day abroad.
- Client meals are reimbursable up to INR 2,500 per person, with the client names and purpose recorded in the claim.
- Team events are limited to INR 1,500 per person per quarter and need prior manager approval.

5. Learning, Wellness, and Other Budgets

- Learning budget: INR 40,000 per employee per calendar year for courses, certifications, books, and conferences. Unused amounts do not carry forward.
- Wellness budget: INR 6,000 per employee per year for gym memberships, fitness apps, or counselling.
- Phone allowance: INR 800 per month for employees in client-facing roles, paid through payroll.

6. Not Reimbursable

- Alcohol, tobacco, and personal entertainment
- Traffic fines, parking penalties, and other legal fines
- Personal travel extensions and first-class travel
- Expenses without a receipt above INR 500
- Spouse or family travel costs

7. Advances, Corporate Cards, and Payment

- Travel advances of up to 80 percent of the estimated cost can be requested at least 5 working days before travel. The advance must be settled within 10 working days of returning.
- Corporate cards are issued to Directors and above, and to employees who travel more than 6 times a year with Finance approval.
- Approved claims are paid within 10 business days of final approval, directly to the employee's salary account.